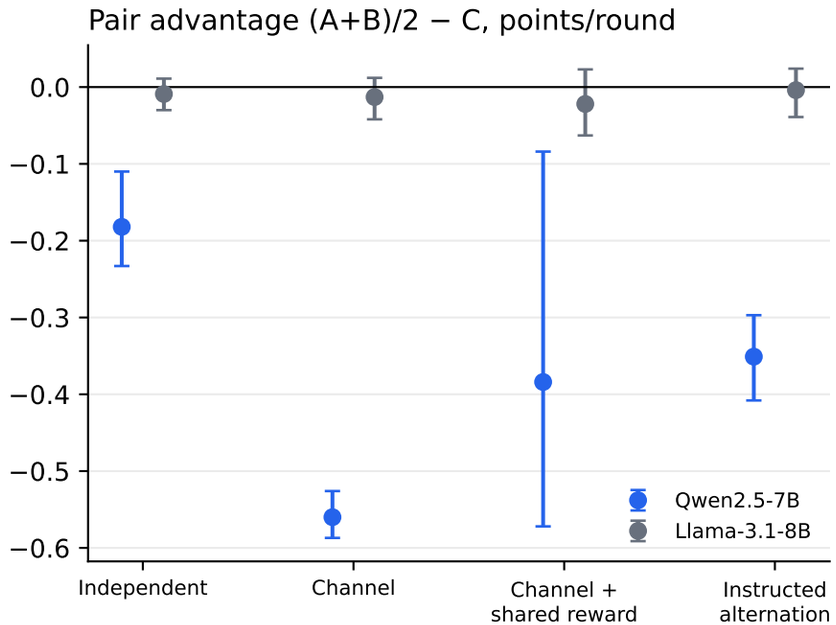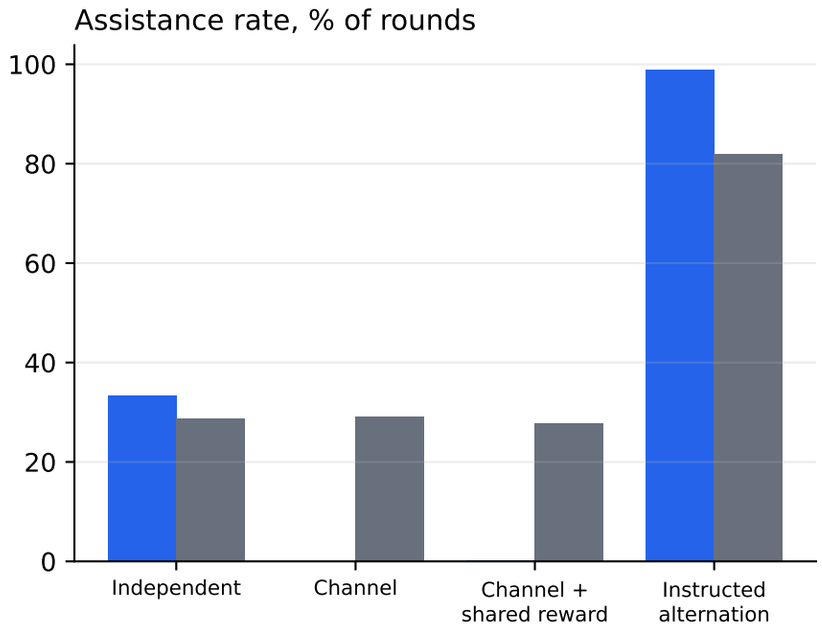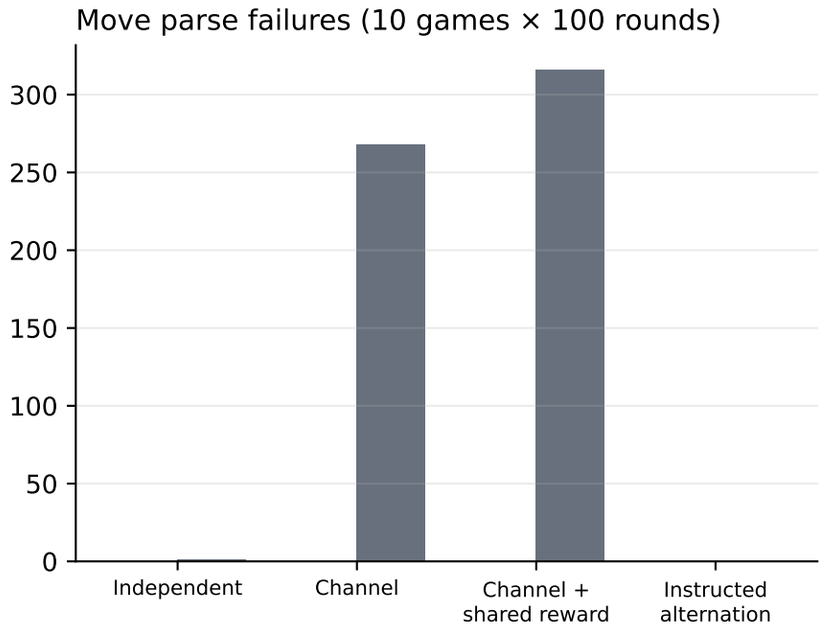Step 1 — v1 prompts, 7–8B models: assistance can be instructed, but never pays